

CLUB / STATE TEAM OF THE YEAR

Saurashtra



Discipline: Cricket

It was an incredible season for Saurashtra as it won two titles, first the Vijay Hazare Trophy, followed by the Ranji Trophy. Under the leadership of Jaydev Unadkat and Arpit Vasavada, the side dominated the others despite the absence of its star batter Cheteshwar Pujara. This was Saurashtra's second Ranji Trophy title win in three years.

Chennai Super Kings



Discipline: Cricket

The M.S. Dhoni-led Chennai Super Kings (CSK) won the Indian Premier League (IPL) for the fifth time, becoming the joint-most successful team in the league. CSK players impressed for national teams as well, with Ruturaj Gaikwad leading India to a gold medal at the Asian Games and Ravindra Jadeja playing a crucial role with bat and ball in India's inspiring journey in the ICC ODI World Cup 2023.

Mohun Bagan Super Giant



Discipline: Football

Mohun Bagan Super Giant, then ATK Mohun Bagan, held its nerves in a tightly contested Indian Super League final to beat Bengaluru FC 4-3 on penalties and lift its maiden title. It then won its 17th Durand Cup trophy after a 1-0 win over arch-rival East Bengal in the final of the 2023 edition. The team's success extended beyond national competitions as it overcame formidable opponents, including ISL 2021-22 champion Hyderabad FC and Abahani Dhaka from Bangladesh, to qualify for the AFC Cup. Individual excellence was also on display, with Mohun Bagan Super Giant's goalkeeper, Vishal Kaith, earning the prestigious Golden Glove award for being the best goalkeeper in the ISL, last season. Further contributing to its stellar season, forward Dimitri Petratos emerged as the joint-highest goalscorer, highlighting the prowess on both ends of the pitch.



Gokulam Kerala Women



Discipline: Football

Gokulam Kerala Women's football team has firmly established itself as the most successful women's side, exemplified by securing a hat-trick of Indian Women's League titles, including the 2023 season. Gokulam Kerala also displayed resilience, finishing as runner-up in the fiercely competitive 2022-23 Kerala Women's League. The team's success is not limited to the club level, as its players made substantial contributions at the national level too. Indumathi Kathiresan played a crucial role in Tamil Nadu's victory in the Senior Nationals after a five-year gap. Additionally, players like Ashalata Devi and Dangmei Grace made significant impacts with the national team, further emphasising Gokulam Kerala's influence in the broader football context.



Ahmedabad Defenders

Discipline: Volleyball

Ahmedabad Defenders emerged as champion in the Prime Volleyball League 2023. This impressive turnaround solidified its status as the joint-most successful team in the league. Notably, the team's influence extended beyond the league as three of its players, including captain Muthusamy Appavu, made a significant impact representing Team India at the Asian Games.